Prompt A — Medium A: Acrylic Painting

Create an acrylic painting of an elderly woman sitting in a chair next to a window. Emphasize texture, contrast, shape, color, and emphasis. Show the details of her face, wrinkles, and hair to communicate wisdom, happiness, and compassion. Use acrylic paintbrushes, layered colors, and varied brushstrokes to create depth and texture. Incorporate layering and blending techniques to create smooth transitions between light and dark areas. Use warm colors to create a peaceful atmosphere, with light coming through the window to emphasize the woman's face.

Prompt B — Medium B: Linocut Printmaking

Create a linocut print of the same elderly woman sitting in a chair next to a window. Keep the original composition, subject, and emphasis on texture, contrast, shape, and line. Use bold carved lines, strong black-and-white contrast, and simplified shapes to show the details of her face, wrinkles, and hair. Use linoleum-carving tools to create varied marks and textures. Apply ink to the carved linoleum surface with a brayer and transfer the image onto paper using pressure. Use positive and negative space to emphasize the woman's expression and communicate wisdom, happiness, and compassion.

Reflection

I chose acrylic painting for my first medium because I like how it allows an artist to use different colors, textures, and brushstrokes. Acrylic paint is also versatile because it can be layered and blended to create different effects. I wanted to create an image of an elderly woman sitting next to a window because I thought it would communicate happiness, wisdom, and compassion. I also wanted the lighting from the window to bring attention to her face.

When I changed the image from acrylic painting to linocut printmaking, the overall appearance changed quite a bit. The acrylic painting allowed more realistic details, smooth color transitions, and different shades. The linocut version used stronger contrast, bold lines, and simplified shapes. Instead of relying on color and blending, the printmaking version relied more on the contrast between black ink and the unprinted paper.

Each medium communicates differently. Acrylic painting can create a softer and more realistic feeling because of the ability to blend colors and build layers. Linocut printmaking creates a stronger graphic appearance and makes the viewer focus more on outlines, shapes, and contrast.

One limitation I discovered with linocut printmaking is that it is harder to include small details and gradual shading. However, it also creates opportunities to make interesting textures through carved lines. Acrylic painting offers more freedom with color and blending, but it requires building up the image through multiple layers.

The tools and processes make a major difference in the final artwork. Paintbrushes allow an artist to control color and texture, while carving tools create permanent marks in the linoleum. Changing the medium also changed how I interpreted the artwork. The acrylic version felt warmer and more realistic, while the linocut version felt more dramatic and bold. Overall, this assignment helped me understand how different artistic mediums can communicate different feelings even when the subject and composition stay the same.